

Girl Scouts Takes Another Left Turn-This Time Toward Islam

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For decades, the Girl Scouts was regarded as one of America's most wholesome institutions--a place where girls learned responsibility, service, leadership and practical skills. That image, however, is becoming increasingly difficult to reconcile with the organization many Christian parents see today.

What once focused primarily on developing young women has steadily moved toward the broader progressive culture. Controversies have included transgender ideology, concerns surrounding sexuality and abortion-related associations, and now increasingly visible Islamic religious activities conducted under the Girl Scout banner.

At some point, Christian parents have to stop asking whether every individual troop is problematic and ask a more important question: What kind of worldview is this organization helping normalize in our daughters?

The latest warning sign is Islam.

Girl Scouts of the USA officially recognizes Islamic religious awards administered through the Islamic Committee on Girl Scouting. Programs connected with Girl Scouting have included instruction about Ramadan, Islamic prayer, the Five Pillars of Islam and Hajj.

Recent reports have documented mosque-based troops incorporating Islamic practices directly into their activities. At a Girl Scout-related event at the SALAM Islamic Center in Sacramento, girls were reportedly invited to try on hijabs, learn about Islamic modesty, tour the mosque and visit an informational booth about Palestine.

Years earlier, Girl Scouts Heart of Central California highlighted troops operating from the same mosque, including a Ramadan sleepover involving fasting and girls "praying through the night."

This goes beyond simply teaching girls that Muslims exist and should be treated respectfully. There is an important difference between learning about another religion and placing its religious observances, symbols and instruction inside an organization parents may assume is religiously neutral.

This Is Part Of A Much Larger Pattern

The concern over Islam might be easier to dismiss if it stood alone, but it follows years of controversy over the direction Girl Scouts has taken on some of America's most divisive cultural issues.

Girl Scouts has embraced gender-identity policies that many Christian families believe directly contradict the biblical understanding of male and female. GSUSA has allowed transgender-identifying youth to participate when they are recognized and living as girls, while some local councils have gone further by explicitly embracing transgender and nonbinary identities.

Consider the contradiction: an organization created specifically for girls now operates within a cultural framework that increasingly treats biological sex as secondary to gender identity. That isn't merely an accommodation around the edges; it raises fundamental questions about what a girls-only organization now believes a girl actually is.

Christians have also raised concerns for years about the organization's associations, materials and broader ideological direction regarding pro-abortion indoctrination.

The Problem Is Not Muslim Children

Christians should also be clear that this isn't an argument for mistreating Muslims or their children. Christians are commanded to love their neighbors, and Muslim families deserve dignity and respect.

But love does not require theological confusion.

Islam and Christianity aren't simply two cultural expressions saying roughly the same thing about God. They make fundamentally different claims about Jesus Christ, Scripture, salvation and the nature of God.

Christianity teaches that Jesus Christ is the eternal Son of God, crucified for our sins and bodily raised from the dead. Islam rejects Christ's deity and central elements of the Christian Gospel. These aren't minor theological differences; they concern the foundation of salvation.

So when Christian parents see girls encouraged to explore Islamic practices, wear Islamic religious dress, learn the Five Pillars or observe Islamic prayer under the umbrella of an organization still associated with traditional American values, they have every right to ask what is being normalized.

Reverse the situation. Would an Islamic youth organization bring Muslim children into a church and encourage them to study the Trinity, recite Christian creeds and learn why Jesus Christ is Lord?

Few would expect it to.

Why, then, should Christians feel embarrassed about maintaining clear boundaries around the religious formation of their children? That isn't intolerance. It is discipleship.

The Real Battle Is Over Formation

The larger issue is that children are always being formed. The questions are who is doing the forming, what worldview is being communicated and where that worldview ultimately leads.

Parents may think their daughter is simply earning badges, camping, selling cookies and

performing community service. Yet organizations also communicate values through what they celebrate, normalize and present as virtuous.

When those assumptions begin conflicting with Christianity, the issue is no longer merely recreational. It becomes spiritual.

Christian families have watched schools, universities, corporations, entertainment companies, mainline denominations and youth organizations undergo dramatic cultural transformations while retaining familiar names and branding.

The mistake is assuming that because an organization was trustworthy 30 years ago, it represents essentially the same values today. A familiar logo doesn't guarantee a familiar worldview, and nostalgia should never replace discernment.

There Is A Christian Alternative

Parents don't have to choose between abandoning scouting altogether and accepting an organization whose direction troubles them.

American Heritage Girls offers a clear alternative.

Founded in 1995 by former Girl Scout volunteer Patti Garibay and other parents seeking an explicitly Christian scouting organization, American Heritage Girls describes itself as a Christ-centered leadership and character-development ministry for girls.

Its statement of faith affirms Scripture, the Trinity, the lordship of Jesus Christ, humanity's creation in God's image and biblical standards concerning marriage and sexual morality.

Girls can still enjoy camping, service, leadership, adventure, friendships and badges. The difference is that those activities occur within an organization that openly identifies the worldview guiding them.

Christians Need To Pay Attention

The question isn't whether every Girl Scout leader is progressive or every troop promotes transgender ideology or Islamic religious activities.

The question is whether the larger organization has moved far enough away from traditional Christian convictions that parents should reconsider placing their daughters under its influence.

Parents have only a limited number of years to shape their children's worldview. Those years shouldn't be casually handed over to organizations moving in a fundamentally different direction.

Christians don't need to respond with hostility, but they do need discernment. The Girl Scouts name may still sound wholesome, the uniform may still look familiar and the cookies may still taste the same.

But the worldview surrounding the organization has changed.

Christian parents would be wise to notice before their daughters absorb lessons they never intended to teach.

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